Major gift · $1.5M over three years

Riverstone Reads

A child who can't read by fourth grade rarely catches up. We make sure they do.

In our city, two of every three low-income third graders read below grade level.

Riverstone Reads runs daily one-on-one tutoring inside public elementary schools, pairing a trained volunteer with the same child all year. We work where the children already are, with the teachers who already know them.

- Reading on grade level by fourth grade is the single strongest predictor of high-school graduation.
- A child who falls behind early almost never closes the gap without help.

Meet Daniela — she started second grade unable to read a single sentence.

When Daniela joined Lincoln Elementary, she scored in the 9th percentile for reading and hid at the back of the room during story time. Her teacher flagged her for Riverstone Reads in October.

- She was paired with Marcus, a retired postal worker, for 30 minutes every school day.
- By spring she was reading chapter books aloud — and raising her hand.

Daniela's year

+2.4 grades

of reading growth in a single school year

— from the 9th percentile to grade level.

Daniela is not the exception. She is what our model does at scale.

The research on early literacy is settled: consistent, relationship-based tutoring moves children faster than any classroom intervention alone. Our job is to deliver that consistency without fail, to every child we take on.

- Same tutor, same child, every school day — relationship is the active ingredient.
- Teachers refer; we never replace them, we multiply their reach.

> *Marcus didn't just teach my daughter to read. He showed up every single day, so she learned that someone always would.*

— DANIELA'S MOTHER, LINCOLN ELEMENTARY

Impact · 2025–26 school year

Across 14 schools, the children we serve are catching up — and staying caught up.

Measured against district peers with the same baseline reading scores.

1,180
CHILDREN TUTORED

86%
MET GRADE-LEVEL GROWTH

+1.7
AVG GRADE GAIN / YR

92%
RETURN NEXT YEAR

The opportunity ahead

4,000

children in our city's lowest-income schools are still on the waitlist for a reading tutor.

The economics of early reading

Every dollar spent on a tutor now saves the public far more later.

Cost-of-inaction modeled on district remediation, grade-retention, and dropout data.

$1,100
COST TO TUTOR ONE CHILD / YR

$9,400
PUBLIC COST OF ONE RETAINED GRADE

8.5×
RETURN PER DOLLAR INVESTED

30 min
DAILY TUTORING PER CHILD

We are ready to grow — the only thing missing is funded tutors.

Our model is proven, our school partnerships are signed, and our volunteer pipeline is full. Each new site needs a paid site coordinator and tutoring materials; everything else, our communities already provide.

- 11 principals have formally requested a Riverstone Reads program for next year.
- We can open a new school in 60 days once a site is funded.

The three-year plan · your gift at work

What a $1.5M commitment builds, year by year.

WORKSTREAM	YEAR 1 · 2026–27	YEAR 2 · 2027–28	YEAR 3 · 2028–29
Schools served	✓ 14 today	− 22 schools	○ 30 schools
Children reached	✓ 1,180	− 1,900	○ 2,800
Site coordinators	✓ 9 funded	− 15 funded	○ 21 funded
Outcome tracking	✓ Annual gains	− Live dashboard	○ District-wide study

✓ Shipped − In flight ○ Planned

The plan · 2026–2029

By 2029 your gift doubles the children we reach — without diluting results.

2,800

children tutored / yr

UP FROM 1,180 ✓2.4× YEAR 3

30

partner schools

UP FROM 14 ✓+16 SCHOOLS YEAR 3

86%

hold grade-level growth

QUALITY HELD AT SCALE ✓TARGET VERIFIED

We are inviting you to fund 1,600 more children into reading.

COMMIT $1.5M OVER THREE YEARS

Funds 12 new school sites and the coordinators who make daily tutoring reliable.

FUND A SINGLE YEAR

Opens schools we cannot promise to keep — the relationship that drives results breaks.

WAIT FOR MATCHING GRANTS

Cedes another cohort of children the early window that never reopens.

Amara Hollis · Executive Director · amara@riverstonereads.example

Let's make sure every child can read.